

Maria Silva

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Dear Hiring Manager,

The paralegal role at this boutique litigation firm, advertised through Ryder Reid Legal, is the kind of position I have been specifically working toward. My year at BCLP's disputes teams, combined with my current advisory work at Citizens Advice, gives me direct experience of the core responsibilities the role involves.

At BCLP I supported two distinct litigation and arbitration teams over twelve months. In international arbitration, I reviewed and organised evidence for procedural submissions and a claimant's memorial, drafted procedural histories, and coordinated documents under time pressure. A few months into the placement I became the only junior supporting the team ahead of a significant submission deadline. That meant tracking every outstanding action, chasing the right people, and making sure nothing was missed. The partner and associate I worked with told me my performance was comparable to a newly qualified solicitor. In real estate disputes, I prepared electronic hearing bundles, assisted with skeleton arguments, conducted research on rights of light and leasehold issues, and managed large volumes of documents across competing matters using iManage. Both rotations involved exactly the kind of document review and bundle preparation that complex litigation requires.

At Citizens Advice I manage matters from first interview to submission: taking detailed factual statements, identifying evidential gaps, drafting correspondence and procedural documents, and maintaining confidential case records to deadline. Working with clients on housing, employment and welfare matters has also made me comfortable handling sensitive situations, translating complicated rules into clear guidance, and making sound judgements about what a matter actually needs.

What draws me to a boutique specialising in high-value disputes, rather than a larger general practice, is the depth of exposure. At BCLP I noticed how much more I learned when a matter was genuinely complex and the team was small enough that everyone's contribution was visible. A 12-month role leading to a training contract, in a firm that works on that kind of litigation, is a direct continuation of the path I have been building since my LLM in comparative and international dispute resolution at Queen Mary. I am ready to work at that level and to take on real responsibility from the start.

Yours sincerely,
Maria Silva